

Find the Hidden Octopus – Mobile Game UI/UX Case Study

Project Overview

Find the Hidden Octopus is a casual hidden-object mobile game designed for iOS and Android. Players search detailed underwater environments to locate a hidden octopus before the timer expires. The project focuses on accessibility, engagement, progression, and monetization while maintaining a fun and approachable experience.

My Role

UI/UX Designer, Game UI Artist, and Unity UI Implementer. Responsibilities included visual design, UX flow creation, mobile interface design, popup systems, progression screens, icon integration, and Unity implementation.

Design Goals

Create a colorful underwater experience, simplify navigation, improve readability on mobile devices, support player retention, and provide monetization opportunities without disrupting gameplay.

Target Audience

Casual mobile players, families, children, and hidden-object puzzle fans looking for short, rewarding play sessions.

Visual Design System

The interface uses ocean-inspired blues, purples, and greens. Rounded panels, playful typography, friendly illustrations, and a baby octopus mascot create a cohesive visual identity across all screens.

Core User Flow

Main Menu → Character Unlock → Level Select → Gameplay → Pause/Settings → Success or Failure → Rewards → Next Level.

Key Screens

Main Menu, Level Selection, Gameplay HUD, Pause Menu, Settings Menu, Mission Success Screen, Game Over Screen, Time Extension Popup, and VIP Subscription Screen.

Gameplay UX

The HUD provides clear visibility of objectives, timer controls, power-ups, progress indicators, and pause functionality. Large buttons and strong visual hierarchy improve usability.

Monetization

VIP subscriptions remove ads and offer premium rewards. Rewarded advertisements provide extra time and encourage continued gameplay without forcing purchases.

Accessibility

Large touch targets, high-contrast buttons, readable typography, and clear iconography improve usability across different screen sizes and age groups.

Unity Implementation

Built using Unity Canvas-based UI systems with reusable prefabs for menus, rewards, settings, and popup screens. Assets were optimized for mobile performance and scalability.

Outcome

The final product delivers a polished mobile experience with strong visual consistency, intuitive navigation, engaging progression systems, and player-friendly monetization.